



ASK A DOCTOR

I'm going on vacation to a tropical climate. Can I have vaccinations? It's advisable to avoid traveling to parts of the world where there is a high risk of disease unless you really need to. Local health care might not be adequate and food and water may be contaminated. If you can't postpone your vacation, be aware of the following:

- Oral vaccines to protect against yellow fever, typhoid, polio, and anthrax, for example, are contraindicated during pregnancy. Your doctor may decide that if you need to travel, the risk of having the vaccine is lower than the risks associated with contracting the disease.
- Some vaccines (polio and typhoid) are safe when given by injection. Mefloquine tablets, to prevent malaria, are considered safe after week 16.
- It's safe to have a tetanus vaccination if you're pregnant; check whether yours is up-to-date.